

Herald



Herald — Slack Channel Setup Guide

Field	Value
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Revision	2
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Status	LIVE adapter — code complete; awaiting operator credentials for E127 live evidence (HRD-115 open, operator-gated on a LIVE round-trip per §107.x; HRD-116 qaherald Slack client + HRD-118 e2e wiring already Fixed)
Spec ref	V4 §11 (Slack capabilities + Web API surface) + §32.2 (subscriber-reply continuous-transport loop) + §43 (multi-channel pherald listen)
HRD	HRD-115 (Slack channel adapter live integration), HRD-116 (qaherald Slack MessengerClient), HRD-118 (e2e E124–E131 multi-channel invariants)
Env vars	HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN (xoxb-...), HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN (xapp-..., Socket Mode), HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID (C0123ABCD), HERALD_SLACK_OPERATOR_USERNAME (optional, attribution per §109)
Code	commons_messaging/channels/slack/ (slack-go vendored as github.com/slack-go/slack) + qaherald/internal/messenger/slack.go (raw-HTTP QA client)

This guide walks you through every step needed to enable Slack in Herald — from creating the Slack app to verifying the live integration test passes. Once you complete these steps, set the env vars in your shell or `.env`, hand the tokens back to the operator, and we will close HRD-115 with live E127 evidence under `docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-<run-id>/`.

This is a risk-classified messenger service. A leaked `xoxb-/xapp-` token can let an attacker read and post in your workspace. Read [§8 — Token security](#) before you paste any token anywhere. Herald never commits tokens and the adapter redacts them out of every error string (see §8).

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Pre-requisites

- A Slack workspace where **you are allowed to install apps**. Some workspaces restrict app installation to admins or require admin approval; if so, you'll submit a request and an admin approves it (this is normal — see §9).
- The Herald checkout at `/Users/milosvasic/Projects/Herald` (or wherever you cloned it).
- Either:
 - podman or docker available locally (for the quickstart compose stack), OR
 - a reachable Postgres instance per the §"Postgres" entries in [../OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md](#).
- Go 1.25+ (the live test runs `go test`).

1 — How Slack fits into Herald (architecture)

Herald's Slack support is the **second** concrete `channels.Channel` implementation (Telegram was first, in Wave 6). It lives at `commons_messaging/channels/slack/` and registers itself with the channels registry under the name "slack" via an `init()` so `pherald listen --channels slack` resolves it at runtime.

The adapter uses **two different transports** — this is the single most important thing to understand before you provision tokens:

Direction	Transport	Slack methods	Token required
Outbound (Herald → Slack)	Slack Web API (HTTPS request/response)	<code>chat.postMessage</code> , <code>files.uploadV2</code> , <code>files.info</code> , <code>auth.test</code>	bot token <code>xoxb-...</code>
Inbound (Slack → Herald)	Socket Mode (a persistent outbound WebSocket — the Slack equivalent of Telegram's <code>getUpdates</code> long-poll)	Events API over the WebSocket (message events)	both the bot token <code>xoxb-...</code> AND an app-level token <code>xapp-...</code>

Concretely:

- `Adapter.Send / Adapter.SendReply` (in `send.go`) call `chat.postMessage`. The `Receipt.ChannelMsgID` carries the real Slack `ts` returned by the server — not a synthetic Herald UUID. Threaded replies set `thread_ts` (the `MsgOptionTS slack-go` option) so a reply threads under the parent message (§32.9 reply anchor). Attachments fan out via `files.uploadV2` with the same `thread_ts`.
- `Adapter.BotSelfIdentity / Adapter.HealthCheck` (in `selfidentity.go / healthcheck.go`) call `auth.test`. The returned `user_id` is the bot's own id — Herald caches it and uses it as the §32.9 anti-echo-loop anchor so the

bot never reacts to its own posts. A degenerate `ok=true` response with an empty `user_id` is rejected as an echo-loop hazard.

- `Adapter.Subscribe` (in `subscribe.go`) runs the **Socket Mode** event loop. It **requires** the app-level token (`xapp-...`); constructing it without one is a deterministic boot error (`slack.Subscribe: app-level token (xapp-...) required for Socket Mode`). Each inbound message event becomes a `commons.InboundEvent`; the bot's own echoes are dropped via the cached self-identity; file shares trigger content-addressed downloads (`files.info` → `url_private_download`) into the per-channel inbox.

There is a **separate** Slack client used only by the QA bot: `qaherald/internal/messenger/slack.go`. It is a small raw-HTTP client (NOT the slack-go SDK) that drives pherald [?] Slack round-trip automation for §107.x evidence. It uses `conversations.history` with an `oldest=ts` watermark in place of a `getUpdates` equivalent (Slack has none). The live test you will run in §7 exercises this QA client.

Negative finding (honest divergence). The qaherald QA client currently ships the **deprecated single-step** `files.upload` (Slack deprecated it in 2025 in favor of the two-step V2 flow `files.getUploadURLExternal` + `files.completeUploadExternal`). This is documented in the `slack.go` header as known-future-cleanup; it is functionally equivalent against the hermetic test seam and swappable without API breakage. The **production channel adapter** (`commons_messaging/channels/slack/`) already uses the current `files.uploadV2`. If your live attachment upload via qaherald fails with a deprecation error, this is the cause — text Send/Reply (the E127 path) is unaffected.

2 — Step 2 — Create the Slack app

Slack apps are managed at <https://api.slack.com/apps>.

1. Open <https://api.slack.com/apps> in a browser and sign in to the workspace where you'll install Herald.
2. Click **Create New App**.
3. Choose **From scratch** (the manifest route also works, but "from scratch" matches this guide step-by-step).
4. Enter an **App Name** — e.g. Herald Notifier, Herald CI, MyProject Herald.
5. Pick the **workspace** to develop the app in (the workspace whose channel you'll post to).
6. Click **Create App**. You land on the app's **Basic Information** page.

The app is owned by your workspace. Anyone with the app's tokens can act as the bot — keep the management page and tokens private.

3 — Step 3 — OAuth scopes + install → get the xoxb - bot token

The bot token (`xoxb-...`) is what Herald uses for **all outbound** calls. You grant it specific **bot token scopes**, then install the app to mint the token.

1. In the left sidebar, open **OAuth & Permissions**.
2. Scroll to **Scopes** → **Bot Token Scopes** and click **Add an OAuth Scope** for each scope below.

The scopes Herald's adapter actually needs (verified 2026-05-31 against the official scope reference — see [Sources verified](#)):

Scope	What it grants (official wording)	Why Herald needs it
chat:write	"Send messages as your Slack app"	Required. Every outbound message (<code>chat.postMessage</code>) — <code>Send</code> , <code>SendReply</code> , and the qaherald QA client. <code>auth.test</code> works with no scope, but a usable bot needs this.
channels:history	"View messages and other content in public channels that your Slack app has been added to"	Inbound (Socket Mode message events) + the qaherald QA client's <code>conversations.history</code> polling when the target is a public channel .
groups:history	"View messages and other content in private channels that your Slack app has been added to"	Same as above when the target is a private channel . Add this only if your <code>HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID</code> points at a private channel.
files:read	View files shared in channels the app is in	Inbound attachment download (<code>files.info</code> → <code>url_private_download</code>) when subscribers share files.
files:write	Upload/edit/delete files as the app	Outbound attachment fan-out (<code>files.uploadV2</code> in the adapter; <code>files.upload</code> in qaherald). Needed only if you send attachments.

Optional / situational:

- `chat:write.public` — "Send messages to channels your Slack app **isn't a member of**" (requires `chat:write` too). Add this **only** if you want Herald to post to a public channel **without** inviting the bot (§5). The simpler, recommended path is to invite the bot and skip this scope.
- `im:history` / `mpim:history` — read message history in **DMs / multi-person DMs**. Add these only if your target "channel" is a DM or group DM (the `oldest-watermark` `conversations.history` poll needs the matching `*:history` scope per conversation type).
- `channels:read` / `groups:read` — list/inspect channel metadata. The adapter does not require these for the core Send/Reply/Subscribe path; the qaherald Preflight self-check calls `conversations.info` and `conversations.members`, which need `channels:read` / `groups:read` if you run the preflight. They are NOT needed for E127.

Minimum for E127 (text Send + reply round-trip in a channel you invite the bot to): `chat:write` + `channels:history` (public channel) or `groups:history` (private channel). Everything else is for attachments, DMs, or preflight.

1. Still on **OAuth & Permissions**, scroll to the top and click **Install to Workspace** (or **Request to Install** if your workspace requires admin approval — see §9).
2. Review the permission screen and click **Allow**.
3. You're returned to **OAuth & Permissions**. Under **OAuth Tokens for Your Workspace**, copy the **Bot User OAuth Token** — it starts with `xoxb-`:

```
xoxb-<13-digit-team>-<13-digit-bot>-<24-char-secret>
```

4. **Copy it immediately** to a password manager / secrets vault. This is `HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN`.

Whenever you change scopes later, you **must reinstall** the app (repeat steps 3–5) for the new scopes to take effect — otherwise calls fail with `missing_scope` (§9).

4 — Step 4 — Enable Socket Mode → get the `xapp-` app-level token

Socket Mode is Herald's **inbound** transport — the persistent WebSocket that delivers subscriber messages. It needs a **separate** app-level token (`xapp-...`), distinct from the bot token. (If you only need **outbound** notifications and never inbound replies, you can skip this step and leave `HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN` unset; `Send/HealthCheck` work without it. `Subscribe` will refuse to boot without it.)

1. In the left sidebar, open **Socket Mode**.
2. Toggle **Enable Socket Mode** on. (Official wording: "Toggle the Enable Socket Mode button to turn on receiving payloads via WebSockets.")
3. Slack prompts you to generate an **app-level token**. (You can also do this under **Basic Information** → **App-Level Tokens** → **Generate Token and Scopes**.)
4. Give the token a name (e.g. `socket`) and add the scope `connections:write` — the official scope that "Grants permission to generate websocket URIs and connect to Socket Mode" (verified 2026-05-31). This is the **only** scope an app-level token needs for Herald.
5. Click **Generate**. Copy the token — it starts with `xapp-`:

```
xapp-1-<app-id>-<config-token-id>-<64-char-secret>
```

6. **Copy it immediately** to your vault. This is `HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN`.
7. Open **Event Subscriptions** in the sidebar and ensure it is **On**. Under **Subscribe to bot events**, add `message.channels` (public channels) and/or `message.groups` (private channels) so the bot receives the `message` events that drive `Subscribe`. (Over Socket Mode you do **not** configure a Request URL — events arrive on the WebSocket.)

Negative finding (no signing secret needed). A common Slack setup uses the **Events API over HTTPS webhooks**, which requires a **Signing Secret** to verify request signatures. Herald uses **Socket Mode**, not HTTPS webhooks, so **no signing secret is read by the code**. (An earlier draft of this guide reserved `HERALD_SLACK_SIGNING_SECRET` — that env var is **not** read by the adapter or any test. Do not set it expecting an effect.) Likewise the old `HERALD_SLACK_DEFAULT_CHANNEL` name is **not** used — the real default-channel var is `HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID` (§6).

5 — Step 5 — Find the channel ID + invite the bot

Slack channels are addressed by **ID** (e.g. `C0123ABCD`), not by name — names are renamable, IDs are stable. Herald sends to the ID in `HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID`.

Find the channel ID:

1. In the Slack desktop or web client, open the target channel.

2. Click the channel name at the top to open its details, scroll to the bottom of the **About** tab — the **Channel ID** (e.g. C0123ABCD for a public channel, G... for some private channels) is shown with a copy button.
 - Alternatively, copy the channel's link (right-click the channel → **Copy link**); the ID is the last path segment, e.g. .../archives/C0123ABCD.
3. Paste it somewhere safe. This is HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID.

Invite the bot to the channel (required unless you granted `chat:write.public` for a public channel):

1. In the channel's message box type:

```
/invite @Herald Notifier
```

(use your app's bot display name) and send it. Slack adds the bot to the channel.

If you skip the invite and the bot is not in the channel, `chat.postMessage` returns `not_in_channel` (§9). Inviting the bot is the simplest fix; `chat:write.public` is the alternative for public channels only.

6 — Step 6 — Provide the credentials to Herald (env vars)

Herald reads exactly these env vars for Slack (verified against `pherald/cmd/pherald/listen.go` and `scripts/e2e_bluff_hunt.sh`):

Env var	Value	Used by
HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN	the xoxb-... bot token (§3)	outbound (<code>chat.postMessage</code> , <code>auth.test</code> , <code>files.*</code>); E127 live test
HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID	the target channel ID, e.g. C0123ABCD (§5)	default outbound destination; E127 live test
HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN	the xapp-... app-level token (§4)	inbound Socket Mode (<code>Subscribe</code>)
HERALD_SLACK_QA_USER_TOKEN	a Slack user OAuth token (xoxp-...) of the channel (§7a)	the §11.4.98 self-driving inbound round-trip QA harness (<code>TestSlack_LiveRoundTrip</code>) — drives the <i>user</i> side
HERALD_SLACK_OPERATOR_USERNAME	the operator's Slack	participant attribution / tagging (§109, the <code>HERALD_<CHANNEL>_OPERATOR_USERNAME@username</code> family)

Where to put them. Per [CLAUDE.md](#) credential rules and [../OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md](#):

- Either **export them in your shell** (`~/ .bashrc` / `~/ .zshrc`) — these load **first** and take precedence — or put them in `.env` (git-ignored) as a **fallback** that never overrides an exported shell var.
- A committed `.env.example` documents the names; never commit real values.

Example `.env` block (values are placeholders):

```
HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN=xoxb-<13-digit-team>-<13-digit-bot>-<24-char-secret>
HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID=C0123ABCD
# Only needed if you want inbound (Socket Mode) replies:
HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN=xapp-1-<app-id>-<config-token-id>-<secret>
# Only needed for the §11.4.98 self-driving inbound round-trip QA test (§7a):
# HERALD_SLACK_QA_USER_TOKEN=xoxp-<user-oauth-token>
# Optional — attribution/tagging:
# HERALD_SLACK_OPERATOR_USERNAME=@yourhandle
```

Resolution order (load-bearing). Exported shell vars win; `.env` is fallback only. If a stale shell export shadows your `.env`, the `.env` value is silently ignored — unset `HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN` (or open a fresh shell) if you change credentials.

7 — Step 7 — Verify the live round-trip (E127 / TestSlack_Live_Send)

E127 is the canonical **live Slack Send + reply round-trip** invariant in `scripts/e2e_bluff_hunt.sh`. It is **triple-guarded** to prevent a silent "no tests to run" PASS-bluff — it only runs when **all three** hold:

1. `HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN` is set,
2. `HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID` is set, **and**
3. a func `TestSlack_Live_Send` exists in `qaherald/internal/messenger/*_test.go`.

If any is missing, E127 prints an explicit **SKIP-with-reason** (§11.4.3) citing the hermetic transcripts as the standing evidence — it never silently passes.

The exact command the operator runs (mirrors the e2e check verbatim):

```
cd /Users/milosvasic/Projects/Herald
HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN='xoxb-...' \
HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID='C0123ABCD' \
go test -tags=integration -count=1 -run TestSlack_Live_Send ./
qaherald/internal/messenger/... -timeout=120s -v
```

What it proves (the real assertions live in `qaherald/internal/messenger/slack.go` + its test):

- Send hits `chat.postMessage` and returns the **real Slack ts** (a dotted-float string like `1654.0001`), not a synthetic id — a no-op Send would return an empty `ts` and FAIL the §107 `ErrEmptyResponse` guard.
- The reply path threads under the parent `ts`.
- You should see the test message **arrive in your Slack channel**.

Expected:

```
--- PASS: TestSlack_Live_Send (Xs)
PASS
ok      github.com/vasic-digital/herald/qaherald/internal/messenger    X.XX
```

Or, run the whole smoke and watch the E127 line:

```
bash scripts/e2e_bluff_hunt.sh 2>&1 | grep -E 'E12[4-9]|E13[01]'
```

Where the evidence lands (§107.x). Capture the full bidirectional transcript (your message + the bot's reply, request payloads + full response bodies) and commit it under:

```
docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-<run-id>/
```

(e.g. `docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-20260531T120000Z/transcript.txt`). Hand this back to the operator — this is what closes HRD-115 from "code complete, awaiting live evidence" to **Fixed**. Until it lands, HRD-115 stays open and E127 stays SKIP (the hermetic transcripts at `docs/qa/HRD-115-20260528T080000Z/` + `docs/qa/HRD-116-20260528T090000Z/` are the standing §107 evidence).

Note on the test's current state. As shipped, `TestSlack_Live_Send` is a **future operator-evidence task** — the e2e guard checks for its *presence* precisely so that running `-run TestSlack_Live_Send` against a missing test cannot silently report "no tests to run" as a PASS. If the test is not yet present in your checkout, E127 will SKIP with that exact reason; the hermetic `TestSlackClientSendCrossesWire / TestBuilderSlack` tests (E126/ E131) already exercise the wire path against an `httptest` server.

7a — Step 7a — The fully-automated inbound round-trip (§11.4.98 / `TestSlack_LiveRoundTrip`)

§7 above (E127 / `TestSlack_Live_Send`) proves the **send** side — a real `chat.postMessage` returns a real `ts`. The **inbound round-trip** — a subscriber message arriving over Socket Mode, being dispatched to Claude Code, and getting a reply back — is proven by a separate, fully-self-driving harness: `TestSlack_LiveRoundTrip` (in `qaherald/internal/lifecycle/`, build tag `integration`). This is the §11.4.98-compliant analog of the Telegram/MTPROTO closed-loop harness; it is what closes **HRD-115** from "send-side proven" to a fully-proven round-trip.

Why a separate QA user token is required (the echo-wall). A Slack bot never receives its own messages over Socket Mode — the platform deliberately suppresses self-echoes (and Herald's §32.9 self-filter drops them defensively too). So the pherald bot can never see a message authored by *itself*. To drive a real inbound message the harness needs a **second, distinct identity**:

a Slack **user** (xoxp-...) that posts into the channel as a human would. The bot then receives *that* user's message, exactly as it would in production.

HERALD_SLACK_QA_USER_TOKEN is that user OAuth token:

- **Type:** a **user** token (xoxp-...), NOT a bot token. (Install the app with a **User Token Scope**, or use a token minted for a real workspace user.)
- **Scopes:** chat:write (to post the probe as the user) + channels:history (to read the bot's reply back via conversations.history). Use groups:history instead of channels:history if HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID is a **private** channel.
- **Membership:** the user behind the token **must be a member of** HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID (post + history both require it). Invite the user (or yourself) to the channel first.

What the harness does, with ZERO human action during the run:

1. Builds pherald and spawns pherald listen --channels slack (wired to HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN + HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN, journaling to a temp --qa-out-dir), with a **dedicated Claude session name** so it never collides with your dev session (§11.4.98 rule 2).
2. Waits for the Socket Mode connection, then **posts a unique nonce-bearing probe as the QA user** (chat.postMessage via HERALD_SLACK_QA_USER_TOKEN).
3. Asserts the autonomy chain via the pherald JSONL journal — inbound message (channel:slack) carrying the probe → cc.dispatch → cc.reply — and, as a bonus, reads the bot's reply back via conversations.history.
4. SIGTERMs the listen subprocess and asserts a clean exit.
5. Writes a **redacted** transcript (tokens + wss:// scrubbed) under docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-roundtrip-<TS>/.

The exact command:

```
cd /Users/milosvasic/Projects/Herald
HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN='xoxb-...' \
HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN='xapp-...' \
HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID='C0123ABCD' \
HERALD_SLACK_QA_USER_TOKEN='xoxp-...' \
go test -tags=integration -count=1 -run
    TestSlack_LiveRoundTrip ./qaherald/internal/
    lifecycle/... -timeout=300s -v
```

Without all four credentials (and a claude binary on PATH or HERALD_CLAUDE_BIN), the test **SKIPS with an explicit reason** (§11.4.3) — never a fake pass, never a manual-action prompt.

8 — Token security (§107 redaction, rotation)

- **Never commit a token.** Not in code, a PR, a commit message, a committed .env, a docs/qa/ transcript, or any indexed location. .env is git-ignored; keep it that way.
- **Tokens never leak to logs.** The qaherald Slack client deliberately keeps the token out of every error string — errors name the API method (chat.postMessage failed: ...) but never the URL or token — and a belt-and-braces sanitizeError(msg, token) scrubs any accidental occurrence to [REDACTED]. The test TestSlack_Send_ErrorDoesNotLeakToken pins this with a planted sentinel

xoxb-<planted-sentinel-must-not-leak-7777> and asserts it never appears in error text. The production channel adapter likewise carries the bot token only in the `Authorization: Bearer` header, never in URLs.

- **Two tokens, two blast radii.** xoxb- (bot) can read/post per its granted scopes; xapp- (app-level) can open Socket Mode WebSockets. Rotate **both** if either leaks.
- **Rotate by regenerating.** Bot token: **OAuth & Permissions** → **Reinstall / rotate** (or revoke + reinstall). App-level token: **Basic Information** → **App-Level Tokens** → **revoke** and generate a new one. Git-history scrubbing alone does **not** invalidate a leaked Slack token — you must revoke/rotate on Slack's side.
- **Least privilege.** Grant only the scopes §3 lists for your actual use. Skip `files:write/files:read` if you don't send/receive attachments; skip `chat:write.public` if you invite the bot.

9 — Step 9 — Troubleshooting

All Slack Web API failures return a JSON envelope `{"ok": false, "error": "<reason>"}`; Herald surfaces `<reason>` in the wrapped Go error (token-redacted). The error strings below are the official Slack reason codes (verified 2026-05-31).

Symptom / error	Cause	Fix
<code>invalid_auth</code>	"Some aspect of authentication cannot be validated." The xoxb-token is wrong, revoked, or for the wrong workspace.	Re-copy the Bot User OAuth Token from OAuth & Permissions . Check for trailing whitespace. Confirm the workspace matches.
<code>not_authed</code>	"No authentication token provided." <code>HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN</code> is empty / unset.	Confirm the env var is set in the same shell that runs the test (<code>echo \$ {HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN: +set}</code>). Remember exported shell vars override <code>.env</code> .
<code>not_in_channel</code>	"Cannot post ... to a channel they are not in." The bot was never invited to <code>HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID</code> .	<code>/invite @<bot name></code> in the channel (§5), or add <code>chat:write.public</code> for a public channel and reinstall.
<code>channel_not_found</code>	"Value passed for channel was invalid." Wrong / mistyped channel ID, or a private channel the bot can't see.	Re-copy the Channel ID from the channel's About panel (§5). For a private channel the bot must be invited AND you need <code>groups:history</code> .
<code>is_archived</code>	"Channel has been archived."	Unarchive the channel or point <code>HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID</code> at a live channel.
<code>missing_scope</code>	"The token ... is not granted the specific scope permissions required." You added a scope but didn't reinstall, or never added it.	Add the scope (§3), then Reinstall to Workspace so the new scope takes effect. <code>chat.postMessage</code> needs <code>chat:write</code> ; <code>conversations.history</code> needs the matching <code>*:history</code> scope per conversation type.

Symptom / error	Cause	Fix
Socket Mode won't connect / Subscribe errors immediately with "app-level token (xapp-...) required"	HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN is unset, or the app-level token lacks <code>connections:write</code> , or Socket Mode is toggled off.	Generate an xapp- token with <code>connections:write</code> (§4), set <code>HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN</code> , and ensure Socket Mode is enabled.
Inbound events never arrive (Socket Mode connects but no messages)	Event Subscriptions off, or the bot isn't subscribed to <code>message.channels / message.groups</code> , or the bot isn't in the channel, or it lacks <code>channels:history / groups:history</code> .	Enable Event Subscriptions, add <code>message.channels / message.groups</code> , invite the bot, add the matching <code>*:history</code> scope and reinstall.
"empty user_id (echo-loop hazard)" from HealthCheck/BotSelfIdentity	<code>auth.test</code> returned <code>ok=true</code> but no <code>user_id</code> — a degenerate/deactivated token.	Reinstall the app to mint a fresh bot token; confirm the bot user is not deactivated.
App won't install ("requires admin approval")	Workspace restricts app installation.	Click Request to Install ; a workspace admin approves it. This is a workspace policy, not a Herald issue.
<code>files.upload</code> fails / deprecation error (qaherald only)	qaherald ships the deprecated single-step <code>files.upload</code> (§1 negative finding).	Text Send/Reply (E127) is unaffected. For attachments use the channel adapter's <code>files.uploadV2</code> ; the qaherald V2 shim is known-future-cleanup.
Live test SKIPS despite tokens set	One of the E127 triple-guards is unmet (missing <code>HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID</code> , or <code>TestSlack_Live_Send</code> not present in the checkout).	Set all three; confirm <code>grep -l 'func TestSlack_Live_Send' qaherald/internal/messenger/*_test.go</code> . The SKIP reason text states exactly which guard failed.

10 — Step 10 — Pre-deploy operator audit checklist

Run through this before handing credentials to the operator or enabling Slack in production:

☐

App created at <https://api.slack.com/apps> in the correct workspace.

☐

Bot Token Scopes include at least `chat:write` (+ `channels:history` or `groups:history` for the target channel type); attachment scopes (`files:read`/`files:write`) only if used.

☐

App **installed** (or reinstalled after the last scope change) — `xoxb-` token copied.

☐

(Inbound only) Socket Mode **enabled**; app-level xapp- token generated with `connections:write`; Event Subscriptions on with `message.channels / message.groups`.

☐

Channel ID copied; **bot invited** to the channel (or `chat:write.public` granted for a public channel).



HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN, HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID (and HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN if inbound) set in `shell` or `.env`; no real values committed; `.env` is git-ignored.



No HERALD_SLACK_SIGNING_SECRET / HERALD_SLACK_DEFAULT_CHANNEL set expecting an effect (those names are **not** read by the code).



E127 / `TestSlack_Live_Send` runs (or SKIPS with a precise reason); the message arrives in the channel.



Bidirectional transcript captured under `docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-<run-id>/` (§107.x) and handed to the operator.



Tokens stored in a vault; rotation procedure (§8) understood.

11 — Step 11 — Spec + code references

- **Spec:** V4 §11 (Slack channel capabilities + Web API surface), §32.2 (subscriber-reply continuous-transport loop — Socket Mode is Slack's parity with Telegram long-poll), §43 (multi-channel pherald listen).
- **HRDs:** HRD-115 (Slack channel adapter live integration — **open**, operator-gated on LIVE `docs/qa/HRD-115-LIVE-*/` evidence per §107.x); HRD-116 (qaherald Slack MessengerClient — **Fixed**); HRD-118 (e2e E124–E131 multi-channel invariants — **Fixed**).
- **Code (production channel adapter)** — `commons_messaging/channels/slack/`:
 - `slack.go` — Adapter struct + `slack://` URL parser + Capabilities + `init()` registry wiring
 - `send.go` — `Send` / `SendReply` / `SendReplyGeneric` (`chat.postMessage` + `thread_ts` + `files.uploadV2` fan-out)
 - `subscribe.go` — Subscribe Socket Mode event loop (xapp- required) + `dispatchMessageEvent` + self-echo drop
 - `selfidentity.go` — `BotSelfIdentity` (`auth.test`, cached `user_id`, §32.9 anchor)
 - `healthcheck.go` — `HealthCheck` (`auth.test` token-validity probe)
 - `attachments.go` — content-addressed `DownloadAttachment` (`files.info` → `url_private_download`)
- **Code (qaherald QA client)** — `qaherald/internal/messenger/slack.go` — raw-HTTP SlackClient implementing MessengerClient (`Send` / `SendPhoto` / `SendDocument` / `SendVoice` / `GetUpdates` via `conversations.history` watermark / `WaitForReply` / `Download` / `Preflight` / `Me` / `Close`); `sanitizeError` token redaction.
- **Tests:**
 - `commons_messaging/channels/slack/*_test.go` — hermetic httptest suite (E126: `TestSlackSatisfiesChannel`, `TestSlackRegistryWiring`, `TestSlackBotSelfIdentityViaAuthTest`, `TestSlackSendCrossesWireWithText`)
 - `qaherald/internal/messenger/slack_test.go` — `TestSlack_Send_ErrorDoesNotLeakToken` (§8 redaction), builder tests (E131)

- `scripts/e2e_bluff_hunt.sh` — E124–E131 (E127 = LIVE Slack, triple-guarded)
- **Vendored SDK:** `github.com/slack-go/slack` (the channel adapter's Web API + Socket Mode client).
- **Related:** [../OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md](#) (umbrella credentials guide), [../MESSENGER_CHANNELS.md](#) (multi-channel framework), [TELEGRAM.md](#) (the first live-channel guide), [../design/PARTICIPANT_ATTRIBUTION.md](#) (§109 attribution / HERALD_SLACK_OPERATOR_USERNAME).

Sources verified 2026-05-31

Per HelixConstitution §11.4.99 + Herald §108.n (Latest-Source Documentation Cross-Reference Mandate). Every operator-facing instruction in this document was cross-referenced against the LATEST official online Slack documentation before publication. Slack moved its developer docs from `api.slack.com/*` reference pages to `docs.slack.dev/*` (302 redirects observed 2026-05-31); the `api.slack.com/apps` app-management console URL is unchanged.

Last verified: 2026-05-31

Source	URL	Used for
Slack app management console	https://api.slack.com/apps	§2 (Create New App → From scratch → name → workspace), §3 (OAuth & Permissions, Install/Reinstall to Workspace), §4 (Socket Mode toggle, App-Level Tokens).
Using Socket Mode (Events API)	https://docs.slack.dev/apis/events-api/using-socket-mode	§1 + §4 (Enable Socket Mode toggle wording; app-level token prefix <code>xapp-</code> ; generate under Basic Information → App-Level Tokens; events arrive over the WebSocket; <code>apps.connections.open</code>).
Scope reference — <code>connections:write</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes/connections.write	§4 (the exact app-level token scope: "Grants permission to generate websocket URIs and connect Socket Mode").
Scope reference — <code>chat:write</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes/chat.write	§3 ("Send messages as your Slack app").
Scope reference — <code>chat:write.public</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes/chat.write.public	§3 + §5 ("Send messages to channels your Slack app isn't a member of"; requires <code>chat:write</code>).
Scope reference — <code>channels:history</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes/channels.history	§3 (public-channel history; "View messages and other content in public channels that your Slack app has been added to").
Scope reference — <code>groups:history</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes/groups.history	§3 (private-channel history equivalent).
Method reference — <code>chat.postMessage</code>	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/methods/chat.postMessage	§1 + §7 + §9 (required scope <code>chat:write</code> ; <code>channel/text</code> args; error codes <code>channel_not_found</code> , <code>not_in_channel</code> , <code>is_archived</code> , <code>invalid_auth</code> , <code>not_authed</code> , <code>missing_scope</code>).
Method reference — <code>auth.test</code>		

Source	URL	Used for
	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/methods/auth.test	§1 + §9 ("No scopes required"; returns ok/url/team_id/user_id/bot_id; empty user_id ⇒ degenerate token).
Method reference — conversations.history	https://docs.slack.dev/reference/methods/conversations.history	§1 + §3 (requires one of channels:history/groups:history/im:history/mpim:history; oldest Unix-ts lower bound limit default 100/max 999; errors not_in_channel/channel_not_found/missing_scope).
Herald source (the authority on which env vars + methods are actually read)	commons_messaging/ channels/slack/ *.go, qaherald/ internal/ messenger/ slack.go, pherald/ cmd/pherald/ listen.go, scripts/ e2e_bluff_hunt.sh	Env-var names (HERALD_SLACK_BOT_TOKEN/HERALD_SLACK_APP_TOKEN/HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID), the E127 triple-guard, token redaction (sanitizeError / TestSlack_Send_ErrorDoesNotLeakToken), the files.uploadV2-vs-files.upload divergence.

Negative findings (documented honestly per §11.4.99(B)):

1. **No signing secret.** Herald uses **Socket Mode**, not HTTPS Events-API webhooks, so it reads **no** HERALD_SLACK_SIGNING_SECRET. The earlier placeholder reserved that name; it is not wired to anything. Do not expect it to have an effect.
2. **Default-channel var name.** The earlier placeholder used HERALD_SLACK_DEFAULT_CHANNEL; the **actual** code reads HERALD_SLACK_CHANNEL_ID. The placeholder name is dead.
3. **files.upload deprecation.** The qaherald QA client ships Slack's deprecated single-step files.upload (deprecated 2025); the production channel adapter already uses files.uploadV2. E127 (text Send/reply) is unaffected; attachment upload via qaherald is the only impacted path.
4. **Scopes index page.** docs.slack.dev/reference/scopes is a table-of-contents only (no per-scope descriptions inline); the exact wording above was taken from each scope's own reference page (linked individually in this table), not from the index.